

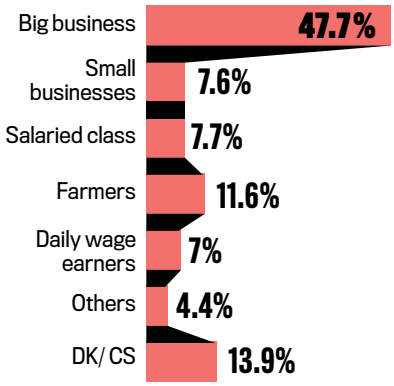
ANI

Q. DO LOCKDOWNS WORK IN PREVENTING THE SPREAD OF COVID AND DO THEY CAUSE AN ADVERSE IMPACT ON LIVELIHOODS?

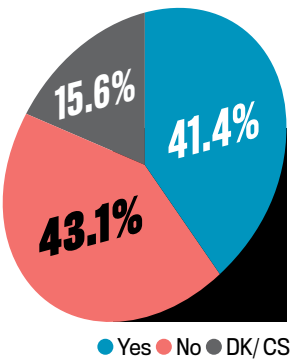
YES, they prevent the spread of Covid, but cause an adverse impact on livelihoods	52.8
YES, they prevent the spread of Covid and don't cause an adverse impact on livelihoods	22.3
NO, they don't prevent the spread of Covid but do cause an adverse impact on livelihoods	13.7
NO, they don't prevent the spread of Covid but also don't cause an adverse impact on livelihoods	5.8
DK/ CS	5.4

(Figures in per cent; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say)

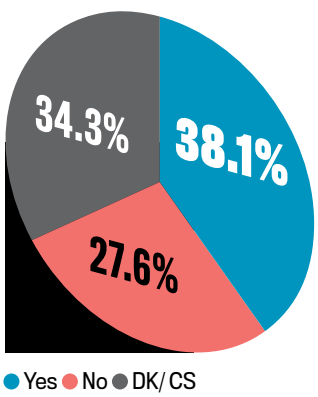
Q. WHO DO YOU THINK HAS BENEFITED THE MOST FROM THE NDA GOVERNMENT'S ECONOMIC POLICIES?



Q. DO YOU SUPPORT THE UNION GOVERNMENT'S DECISION TO PRIVATISE AIR INDIA?



Q. DO YOU WANT THE GOVERNMENT TO BAN CRYPTOCURRENCY IN INDIA?



the pandemic, seem to have benefited the least, with just 7 per cent saying that daily wage earners have benefited the most from the government's policies.

One of the government's major attempted reforms in its second term has been its push to exit public sector enterprises. Though it announced a string of disinvestment proposals, including of Bharat Petroleum Corporation, Shipping Corporation of India and two PSU banks, the Centre has not made much headway this financial year, and will miss its disinvestment target of Rs 1.75 lakh crore by a huge margin. The only relief was the sale of Air India to the Tata Group in October for Rs 18,000 crore, with the Tatas directly paying Rs 2,700 crore and the rest going toward the airline's Rs 15,300 crore debt. But issues like privatisation and disinvestment are tricky. The sale of Air India has split public opinion down the middle—43 per cent of those polled said they did not support privatisation, while 41.4 per cent said they did. Equally strong views have not emerged in the area of cryptocurrencies, where the PM has highlighted the need for a concerted global regulatory effort. While 38.1 per cent of respondents said they wanted the Centre to ban cryptocurrencies, 34.3 per cent were unaware of the issue or did not have a strong view. The Centre is currently discussing regulations with various stakeholders and is expected to legislate on the matter soon.

With the government going into election mode, politics is likely to take precedence over good economics. The Indian economy, though bruised, is on a recovery path. And though issues like inflation don't always make headlines, they do determine the fate of governments. The clouds of the pandemic have not cleared, leaving businesses, policy makers and the general public guessing. India cannot lower its guard if it is to recover from the damage inflicted by Covid-19. ■